

So let's have a look at few of the more popular ones that helps someone through the initial steps of cyber-security investigation:-

1. John The Ripper

(<https://john.colab.io>)

Regarded as one of the best password crackers of all time, it's arguably one of the better security tools available to not only test password strength in one's operating system, but also to check up on one remotely over a network.

It works by auto-detecting the type of encryption used in almost any password, and then changes its password test algorithm based on it thereby making it one of the most automated and aware password cracking tools of all time.

Using brute-force technology, it can decipher passwords and solve through most of the popular algorithms such as:

- DES, MD5, Blowfish; Kerberos AFS; Hash LM (LAN Manager), the method predominantly used in Windows NT / 2000 / XP / 2003/7; MD4, LDAP, MySQL (using third-party modules)

Available platforms: Being open source, it's available for Mac, Linux(all popular distributions), Windows and Android.



2. Metasploit

(www.metasploit.org)

It's an open source cyber-security project that specialises in providing different pen-testing tools to discover vulnerabilities in remote software. Its popularly used as an "exploit module development platform".

Written in Ruby, Metasploit Framework is the most popular product of this project, which enables one to develop, test and execute exploits easily. The framework provides a suite of security tools that can be used to:

- Evade detection systems
- Scan for security vulnerabilities

